Further reading: Halbfass 1995; Potter 1981; Thrasher 1993

Maya: this may mean the real material or substrative cause (*upadana-karana*) from which the universe of worlds emerges and into which it is reabsorbed (***pralaya***). Dualistic theologians think that it is a complex raw material that is stimulated by God to produce types of bodies, faculties and material realities, including space and time. By contrast, some non-dualists (see ***Advaita***) say that *maya* is the Supreme Reality's power of projecting the world comprising matter, differences, limited personal individuality and change. But both the power and the projected cosmos are really not different from the essentially conscious nature of the Supreme. So matter and individuality are not ultimate facts but the way in which reality appears to us. Illusion operates whenever we understand reality as something independent of the foundational Absolute Reality.

Shankara sometimes compares anything illusory, in particular differences grounded in matter and individual agency, to *maya*, meaning a magical trick.

Further reading: Halbfass 1995

Moksha: final liberation from the series of embodied lives in the here and now (***samsara***). The ultimate goal of all paths to salvation, it is achievable by control over physical and mental processes (***yoga***), knowledge (*jnana-yoga*), selfless action, devotion to God (*bhakti-yoga*) or by a combination of some or all of them. Some theistic cults insist that it is given by God. It is ***karma*** that binds one to ***samsara*** and the achievement of liberation requires that one's stock of ***karma*** be completely exhausted.

For the ***Mimamsaka*** ritualists it is depersonalised individual consciousness beyond matter and time, attained by